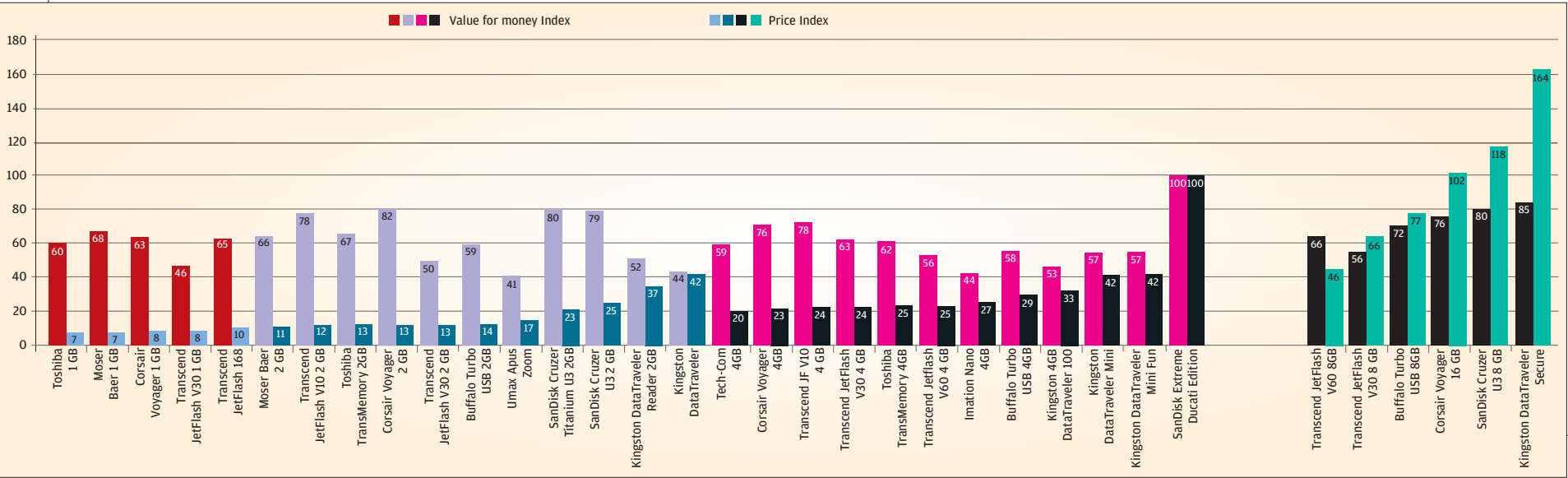


2 GB						4 GB					
BRAND MODEL	SanDisk Cruzer U3 2 GB	Toshiba TransMemory 2GB	Transcend JetFlash V30 2 GB	Transcend JetFlash V10 2 GB	Umax Apus Zoom	Buffalo Turbo USB 4GB	Corsair Voyager 4GB	Imation Nano 4GB	Kingston 4GB DataTraveler 100	Kingston DataTraveler Mini	Kingston DataTraveler Mini Fun
											
Price (Exclusive Of taxes)	1690	860	900	800	1138	2,000	1,550	1,800	2,272	2,850	2,850
Comments	+ Well built - None in particular	+ Attractive looks - Very Slow	+ Compact, good looks - Slow	+ Fast, well built - Bland looks	+ Great Looks - Very Slow	+ Attractive looks - Turbo USB over hyped	+ Rugged, fast - None in particular	+ Cute looking - Slow	+ Good build quality - Slow performer	+ Very Compact - USB Mechanism tacky	+ Cute looking, compact - Mediocre build quality
Grand Totals (Out Of 100)	49.94	42.10	31.81	49.39	25.96	36.90	47.96	27.93	33.56	36.29	35.82
Features	23.73	24.08	15.26	17.01	13.51	13.09	20.86	11.20	15.72	12.74	12.39
Performance	26.21	18.02	16.55	32.38	12.45	23.81	27.10	16.73	17.84	23.55	23.43
Features											
Storage Capacity (Claimed)	2 GB	2 GB	2 GB	2 GB	2 GB	4 GB	4 GB	4 GB	4 GB	4 GB	4 GB
Storage Capacity (Actual)	1.9 GB	1.85 GB	1.9 GB	998 MB	1.9 GB	3.74 GB	3.78 GB	3.82 GB	3.84 GB	3.84 GB	3.84 GB
Security	Y	Y	N	N	N	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Software Features	8	8	0	5	0	0	6	0	0	0	0
Visual Indicators (LED, etc.)	Y	Y	Y	Y	N	N	Y	N	Y	N	N
Other Accessories Provided	NA	NA	lanyard cable	lanyard cable	Lanyard ring	NA	USB Extension cable	NA	NA	NA	NA
Other Features	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA		NA	NA	NA	NA
Build Quality (So 10)											
Quality Of Materials used	7	6.5	5.5	5	7	6.5	7.5	5	6.25	6.5	6
Sturdiness Of The Overall Package	7	7	5.5	5.5	6.75	6.5	7.75	5	6.5	6.5	6.5
Cap Locking Mechanism	6.5	7.5	7	7	6	7	7	7	7	6.5	6.5
Performance											
HD-Tach 3 (8 MB Write Tests)											
Random Access Time	0.5 ms	4.3 ms	0.6 ms	1.1 ms	0.8 ms	0.6 ms	0.7 ms	11.8 ms	1.8 ms	0 ms	1 ms
Average Read Speed	20.5	13.2	18.8	27.6	19.65	20.8	22.2	11.3	13.9	20.6	20.6
Average Write Speed	8.3	4.3	7.1	10.2	4.23	5.4	11	4.8	5.5	6.7	6.6
Read Burst Speed	21.4	13.9	20.2	29.5	21.43	21.3	22.8	11.8	14	21.4	21.4
CPU Utilisation (%)	0.06	0	0.02	0.06	0.05	0.07	0	0.04	0.04	0.1	0.1
SiSoft Sandra 2007 (64MB File Test)											
Read	19.24	12.32	18.56	29.35	17.24	20.75	21.85	9.8	13.1	19.5	19.3
Write	7.72	3.42	4.39	7.72	4.26	4.36	7.64	5.4	4.3	6.17	6.36
File Transfer Test											
Write—100 MB (Sequential)	7.74	4.79	5.76	9.16	1.81	4.32	7.56	5.37	3.92	5.79	5.73
Read—100 MB (Sequential)	20.28	14.31	10.96	30.86	2.16	49.02	24.69	11.21	15.92	26.11	20.33
Write—100 MB (Assorted)	1.53	0.79	0.31	1.57	0.46	0.75	1.00	0.87	0.96	0.59	0.66
Read—100 MB (Assorted)	8.90	18.05	9.79	12.11	1.28	12.63	12.69	11.06	13.07	12.92	13.05
Write—1 GB (Sequential)	7.75	3.80	2.97	7.80	4.37	4.20	7.41	4.98	3.96	5.88	5.88
Read—1 GB (Sequential)	18.21	12.27	10.12	27.34	8.30	19.71	20.75	10.96	12.75	19.53	19.86
Write—1 GB (Assorted Files)	6.37	3.24	2.37	5.27	2.40	3.25	4.36	3.52	2.94	3.88	3.85
Read—1 GB (Assorted Files)	16.59	11.08	7.13	23.52	3.15	17.18	18.40	10.30	12.32	16.34	17.35



The Data Traveler Secure has full 256-bit AES (Rijndael) encryption. This makes the Secure the perfect choice for someone who’s really serious about data protection. Not only can you limit access to the data on the drive but any data placed in the secure folder automatically gets encrypted.

SanDisk’s Cruiser also allows password encryption, which is standard with the U3 interface—and we’d like U3 if it wasn’t for the annoying pop-ups, in fact all U3 based drives are reasonably secure—something of a plus—but the interface leaves a lot to be desired.

Performance

With absolutely nothing to choose from between the speeds of the Buffalo and Kingston drives we knew we had our two performance winners nailed down. The Kingston drive does

better at assorted writes—worth remembering if you intend to copy lots to files to the drive. If your need patterns dictate a lot of reading from the USB drive then the Buffalo would be better. The Transcend JetFlash V60 is the nearest competitor to these two speed demons, but still loses by a small margin. Transcend’s own JetFlash V30 brings up the rear.

Conclusion

If you are a security nut, and more concerned about who’s viewing your personal stuff then go with the Kingston DataTraveler Secure—no more worries except the price: Rs 11,111. If that’s a little too much to cough up, you should look at the U3-based SanDisk Cruiser—for Rs 7,990, you get decent speed, and great build quality. You’ll also get security as all the Cruiser drives come with the U3 inter-